

MODERN STORE OF VALUE

Turner – Hazelwood – McDavid – Moore – Buttrey



The logo for 'investgro' features a small green leaf icon above the word 'investgro' in a bold, green, sans-serif font.

in partnership with Casey Martens from **investgro**

GOLD BASELINE SAFE HAVEN

Historical Trust

Historically been trusted as shields against economic uncertainty

Market Speculation

Recent market shocks have exposed significant volatility



WHY EVEN CARE?



INFLATION ERODES CASH

Cash sitting idle **loses** real purchasing power every single year.



MARKETS ARE VOLATILE

You need somewhere **safe** for **wealth** to survive the chaos.



INSTITUTIONAL FAILURE

Relying on a **single** currency to **safeguard** your wealth is a **single** point of **failure**.

LONG-TERM WEALTH PRESERVATION

A store of value isn't about getting rich fast.

It's about ensuring that what you have today still has value tomorrow.

THE BOTTOM LINE

Whether it's a house, gold, or an ETF — there are a lot of ways to store value.

The question is only ***which ones hold up when it matters most.***

OUR GOAL

NEW

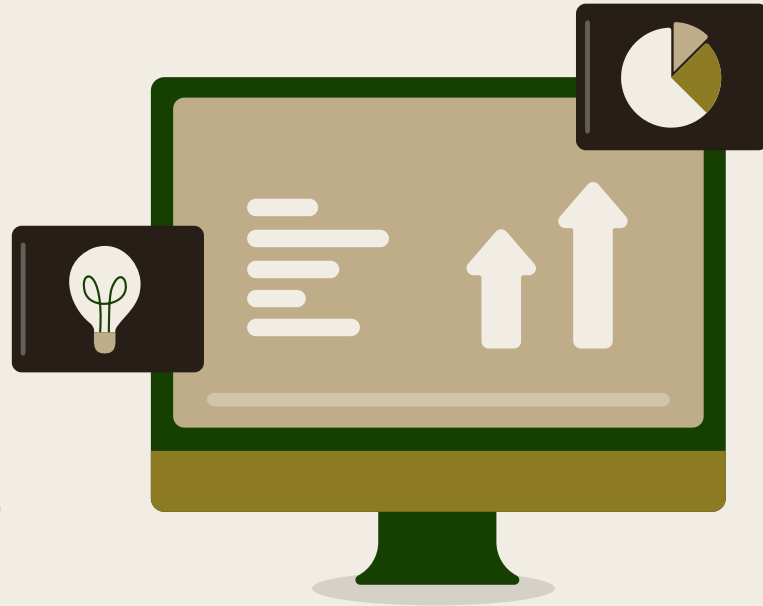
- Analyzing more modern options for stable investment

IMPROVED

- Better real-world performance

CONSISTENT

- Confidence in long term, stable methods of storing money



METRICS

DATA ACQUISITION AND METHODOLOGY

Data Architecture & Tools

yfinance

- Initial extraction method
- *Setback: Rate limiting & inconsistent results*

FRED

- Sourced *"Customer Price Index For All Urban Customers"*
- Establish inflation baseline

Stooq

- Sourced daily historical pricing
- Designed a custom offline processor to parse data

Input Variables & Integration

Market Data

- 23 candidate assets
- 5-year horizon

Inflation Data

- Evaluated as Year-over-Year monthly data

Integration

- Normalized percentile ranking of assets
- Daily market pricing with monthly data reports
- Leveraged VTI for market independence baseline



ASSET SELECTION

- Started with traditional safe havens — metals and bonds
- Added defensive and growth equities for broad coverage
- Agriculture ETFs as inflation-linked real asset exposure
- Crypto ETFs included to stress-test the "digital gold" narrative
- VTI held as the market independence baseline
- Daily pricing via Stooq over a 5-year horizon

ASSET	TICKER	CATEGORY
BROAD MARKET		
S&P 500	SPY	Broad Market ETF
Total Market	VTI	Baseline
SECTOR		
Utilities	XLU	Sector ETF
INDIVIDUAL STOCKS		
NVIDIA	NVDA	Individual Stock
Apple	AAPL	Individual Stock
Microsoft	MSFT	Individual Stock
AMD	AMD	Individual Stock
Amazon	AMZN	Individual Stock
Tesla	TSLA	Individual Stock

ASSET (CONT.)	TICKER	CATEGORY
INDIVIDUAL STOCKS (CONT.)		
Walmart	WMT	Individual Stock
Lowe's	LOW	Individual Stock
Home Depot	HD	Individual Stock
Johnson & Johnson	JNJ	Individual Stock
CRYPTO		
Bitwise	BITW	Crypto ETF
Bitcoin	IBIT	Crypto ETF
Ethereum	ETHA	Crypto ETF
METALS		
Gold	GLD	Metals ETF
Silver	SLV	Metals ETF
Platinum	PPLT	Metals ETF
Palladium	PALL	Metals ETF
AGRICULTURE		
Wheat	WEAT	Agriculture ETF
Soybeans	SOYB	Agriculture ETF
DB Agriculture	DBA	Agriculture ETF

SUCCESS METRICS

Risk Adjusted Returns

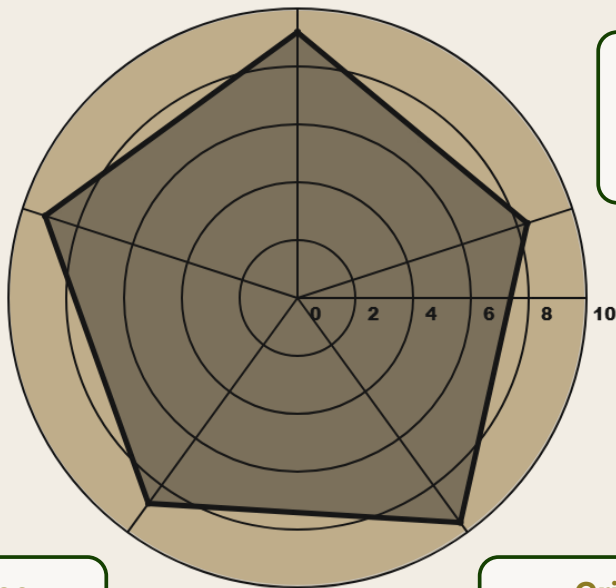
Uses *Sortino Ratio* to measure an asset's return relative to its downside risk

Drawdown Protection

Uses *Calmar Ratio* to compare asset's annualized return against its worst peak-to-through decline

Real Returns

Uses *Inflation-Adjusted Returns* to measure an assets real buying power



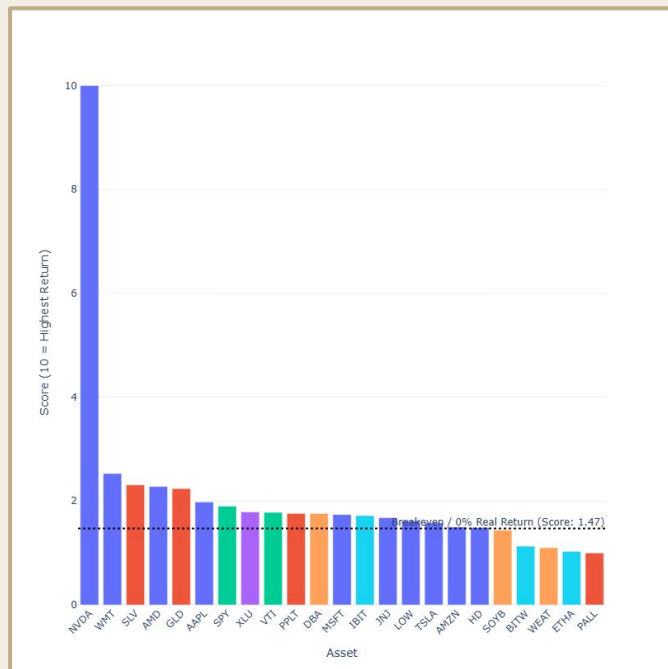
Market Independence

Uses *Pearson Correlation* vs. *VTI* to measure how closely an asset's price movements track the stock market

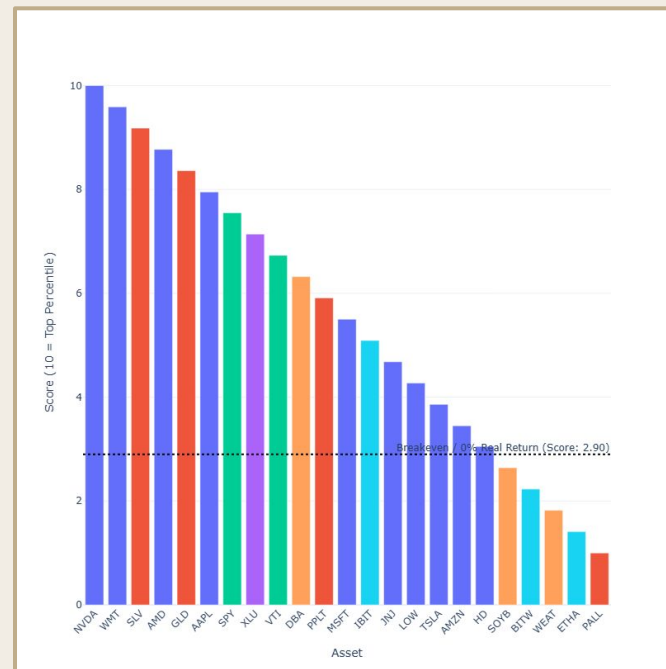
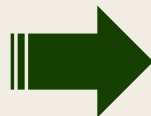
Crisis Performance

Uses formula *Breakeven Return Rate / Time to Recovery* to evaluate how quickly assets recover from market stress

SUCCESS METRIC NORMALIZATION



Raw Metrics



Percentile Normalized

Inflation metric "Real Return" visualized

SCORE AGGREGATION

**Total Composite
Score**

=

Risk Adjusted Return + Real Returns + Crisis Performance +
Market Independence + Drawdown Protection

5

- Average of every success metric after normalization
- Shows the most “balanced” asset
- Keeps the 1-10 range

RESULTS



GOLD

1st OVERALL

Risk Adjusted
Returns

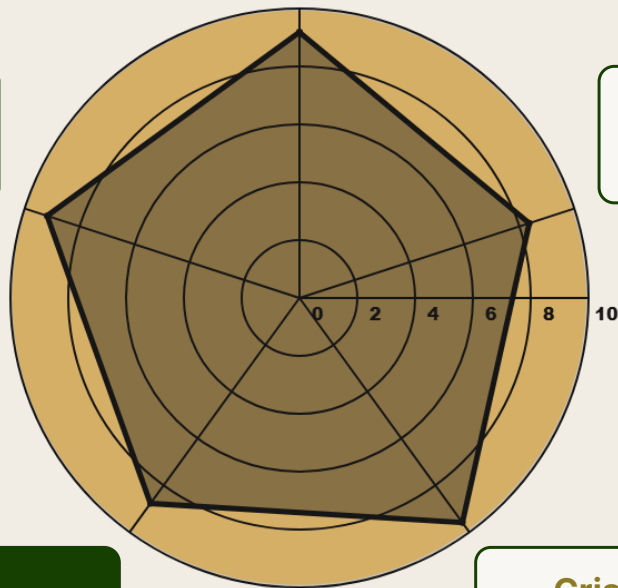
9.18

Drawdown
Protection

9.18

Real
Returns

8.36



Market
Independence

8.77

Crisis
Performance

9.59



WALMART

2nd OVERALL

Risk Adjusted
Returns

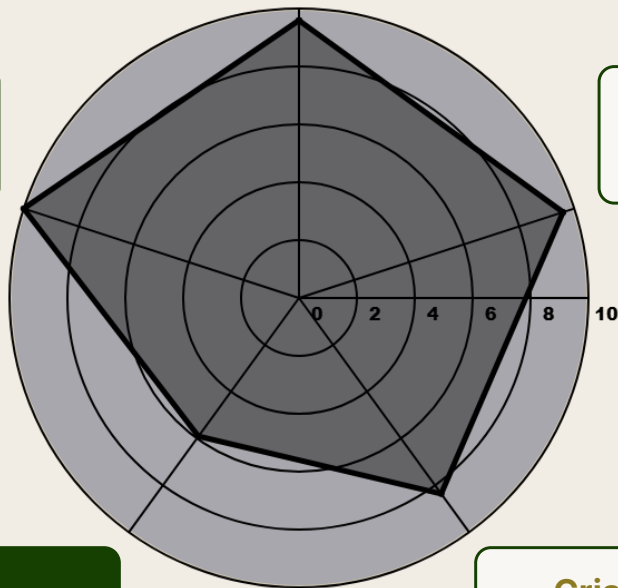
9.59

Drawdown
Protection

10

Real
Returns

9.59



Market
Independence

5.91

Crisis
Performance

8.36



AGRICULTURE ETF

3rd OVERALL

Risk Adjusted
Returns

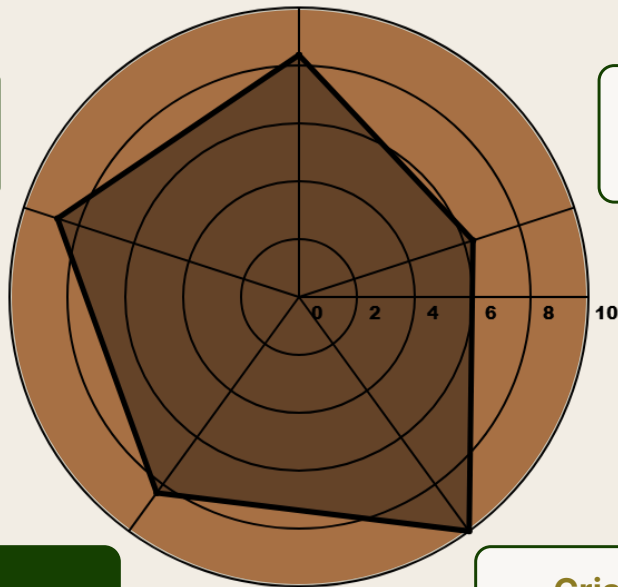
8.36

Drawdown
Protection

8.77

Real
Returns

6.32



Market
Independence

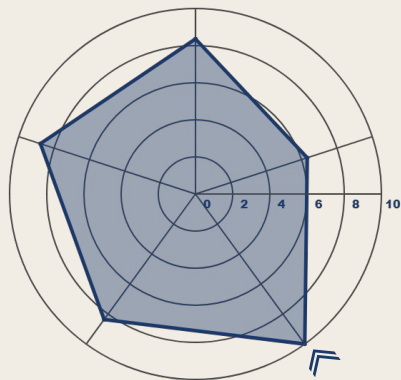
8.36

Crisis
Performance

10

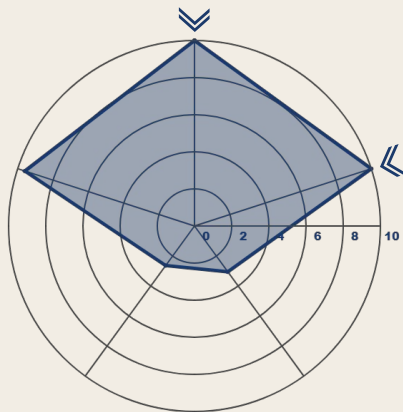
WINNING ASSETS PER CATEGORY

Agriculture ETF
(DBA)



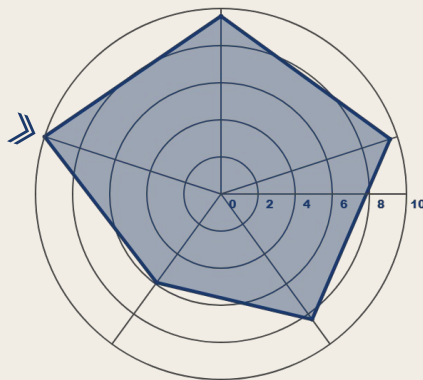
Crisis
Performance

NVIDIA
(NVDA)



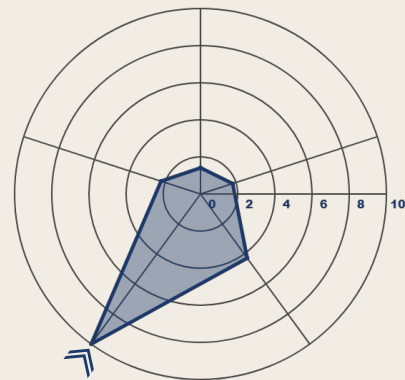
Risk-Adjusted
Returns
&
Real Returns

Walmart
(WMT)



Drawdown
Protection

Wheat
(WEAT)



Market
Independence

DISCUSSION

Non-traditional assets can serve as viable safe havens, but not all alternative asset holds up when it matters most.

- Gold remains the benchmark for capital preservation.
- Defensive consumer equities and agricultural commodities rivaled gold.
- Crypto ETFs and cyclical tech stocks were volatile, risky assets during crises.
- Investors seeking gold-like resilience should consider diversifying across defensive equities and agricultural commodities.



The image features a light beige background with four decorative corner elements. Each corner contains a circular shape with diagonal lines: top-left is white with green lines, top-right is white with green lines, bottom-left is dark green with gold lines, and bottom-right is dark green with gold lines.

FUTURE WORKS

Future Work

WHOLE MARKET ANALYSIS

- Expand analysis from 23 assets to the entire U.S. stock market
- Run pipeline algorithms on the Jetstream cluster
- Identify more non-traditional resilient assets

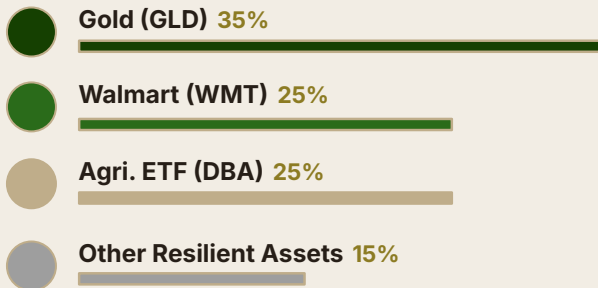


Future Work

Synthetic "Store of Value" ETF

What if the top-ranked assets from our analysis were bundled into a single, investable product weighted by composite score across all five metrics?

PROPOSED HOLDINGS



THE ROADMAP

- 1 Expand scoring to the entire U.S. market via the Jetstream cluster to surface on-traditional candidates beyond our initial 23.
- 2 Holdings and weights update monthly, always drawn from the current top-ranked assets in the pipeline.
- 3 Back-test at five, ten, fifteen, and twenty year horizons.
- 4 Benchmark against gold alone and other established risk-averse portfolios.

CONCLUSIONS

While gold remains a foundational benchmark, modern alternatives like defensive equities (WMT) and agricultural commodities (DBA) offer comparable resilience and market independence. These assets consistently rival traditional metals in drawdown protection during economic uncertainty.

Conversely, high volatility assets like crypto ETFs and cyclical tech stocks fail to function as reliable stores of value during crises. For gold like capital preservation, investors should prioritize defensive consumer and agricultural sectors over speculative digital assets.

THANKS!

**Turner • Hazelwood • McDavid
Moore • Buttrey**



 **investgro**

in partnership with Casey Martens,
Financial Advisor from investgro



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